

Sketch proofs of the ContEst appendix regularity propositions

ContEst supplementary note

July 8, 2026

Abstract

This note gives sketch proofs of the two regularity results proved in the appendices of the ContEst paper: the LQG regularity proposition (Appendix A), under which the covariance-SDP design gradients of the LQG inner problem are exact, and the fixed- γ H_∞ regularity proposition (Appendix B), its robust twin for the game-Riccati inner problem. For each we state the claim, then argue at the level of the decisive identities and the classical theorems they invoke — Slater/conic duality, the discrete algebraic Riccati equation (DARE) and its game analog (GARE), the implicit function theorem via the Stein operator, the Danskin/Bonnans–Shapiro value-derivative formula, and the Alizadeh–Haeberly–Overton characterization of nondegeneracy — explaining briefly why each applies. The fully expanded LQG argument is in the companion `Thm1_proof.tex`; this note is the compact version and additionally covers H_∞ .

1 Common setup and notation

Fix a design point θ in an open set $\Theta_0 \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{r_\theta}$ and the discrete-time model

$$x_{k+1} = A_\theta x_k + B_\theta u_k + w_k, \quad y_k = C_\theta x_k + v_k, \quad (1)$$

$x_k \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $u_k \in \mathbb{R}^m$, $y_k \in \mathbb{R}^p$, with C^1 data $\theta \mapsto (A_\theta, B_\theta, C_\theta, W, V, Q, R)$, noise covariances W, V and stage weights Q, R . We write $\mathbb{S}^q$ for symmetric $q \times q$ matrices, $\langle X, Y \rangle = \text{tr}(X^\top Y)$, and call M *Schur* if $\rho(M) < 1$. Both inner problems are instances of the paper’s generic convex program

$$V(\theta) = \min_z \phi(z, \theta) \quad \text{s.t.} \quad g(z, \theta) = 0, \quad G(z, \theta) \in \mathcal{K}, \quad (2)$$

with $\mathcal{K}$ the PSD cone, Lagrangian $L = \phi + \langle \mu, g \rangle + \langle S, G \rangle$, optimal triple (z^*, μ^*, S^*) . The paper’s Theorem 1 (envelope theorem) states that under its Assumption 1,

$$\nabla_\theta V = \partial_\theta \phi + \langle \mu^*, \partial_\theta g \rangle + \langle S^*, \partial_\theta G \rangle, \quad (3)$$

the partials taken with (z^*, μ^*, S^*) frozen. Assumption 1 asks, on Θ_0 : (A1) convexity, C^1 data, Slater; (A2) unique primal minimizer; (A3) nondegeneracy/strict complementarity, hence a unique dual; (A4) θ enters only through finitely many C^1 data objects. The two propositions below reduce (A1)–(A4) to *system-theoretic* hypotheses that are checkable from the model.

Throughout, the standing system-theoretic hypotheses are

- (S1) the data maps are C^1 in θ ;
- (S2) (A_θ, B_θ) stabilizable and (A_θ, C_θ) detectable;
- (S3) $W, V, R \succ 0$, $Q \succeq 0$ with $(A_\theta, Q^{1/2})$ detectable (automatic when $Q \succ 0$).

2 Appendix A: LQG regularity — sketch

The LQG inner value splits, by the fixed- θ separation principle, into a control SDP and an estimation SDP. In covariance form the control SDP is

$$J_{\text{cont}}(\theta) = \min_{\Sigma, L, Z_0} \text{tr}(Q\Sigma) + \text{tr}(RZ_0) \quad \text{s.t.} \quad \Sigma \succ 0, \begin{bmatrix} Z_0 & L \\ L^\top & \Sigma \end{bmatrix} \succeq 0, \mathcal{G}_c \succeq 0, \quad (4)$$

with $\mathcal{G}_c = \begin{bmatrix} \Sigma - W & A_\theta \Sigma + B_\theta L \\ (A_\theta \Sigma + B_\theta L)^\top & \Sigma \end{bmatrix}$ and optimal gain $K^* = L^*(\Sigma^*)^{-1}$; the estimation SDP is its transpose dual (Section 2.1).

Proposition 1 (LQG regularity). *Under (S1)–(S3), for (4) and its estimation dual and every $\theta \in \Theta_0$: (a) Slater holds; (b) the primal minimizer is unique and equals the stabilizing DARE solution, $\Sigma^* \succ 0$; (c) the value is C^1 and, for every optimal dual, (3) returns $\nabla_\theta V$ (so the design gradients read from the solver’s duals are exact); (d) if in addition the solution is strictly complementary and primal-nondegenerate, the dual is unique and Assumption 1 holds verbatim. Moreover the (1,1) dual block of $\mathcal{G}_c$ equals the control Riccati solution, $S_{11}^* = P$.*

(a) Slater from stabilizability/detectability. Pick K with $A_{\text{cl}} := A_\theta + B_\theta K$ Schur (exists by (S2)). For any $\varepsilon > 0$ the discrete Lyapunov equation $\Sigma = A_{\text{cl}} \Sigma A_{\text{cl}}^\top + W + \varepsilon I$ has a unique solution $\Sigma = \sum_{k \geq 0} A_{\text{cl}}^k (W + \varepsilon I) A_{\text{cl}}^{\top k} \succ 0$ because A_{cl} is Schur and $W + \varepsilon I \succ 0$ (Lyapunov stability theorem for discrete systems). Setting $L = K\Sigma$, $Z_0 = K\Sigma K^\top + \varepsilon I$, the Schur complements of the three LMIs are $\varepsilon I \succ 0$, so the point is *strictly* feasible. Slater for a bounded-below convex conic program gives zero duality gap and dual attainment by the *conic strong-duality theorem* [3, Thm. 2.4.1], [4, §5.9]. This is (A1); (A4) is immediate since θ enters only through $(A_\theta, B_\theta, W, Q, R)$, all C^1 .

(b) Unique primal = DARE solution. Two classical facts do the work. First, the covariance SDP is an exact convex lift of the stationary LQR problem: for feasible (Σ, L, Z_0) with $K = L\Sigma^{-1}$, the Schur complement of $\mathcal{G}_c$ reads $\Sigma \succeq A_{\text{cl}} \Sigma A_{\text{cl}}^\top + W$, and $W \succ 0$ forces A_{cl} Schur (a *Lyapunov-inequality / eigenvector* argument [5, Ch. 5]); iterating the resulting Stein inequality gives $\Sigma \succeq \Sigma_K$, so the objective dominates the stationary LQR cost $J(K) = \text{tr}(Q\Sigma_K) + \text{tr}(RK\Sigma_K K^\top)$. Second, the *completion-of-squares identity*

$$J(K) - \text{tr}(PW) = \text{tr}((K - K^*)^\top (R + B_\theta^\top P B_\theta)(K - K^*) \Sigma_K), \quad (5)$$

with P the stabilizing solution of the DARE $P = A_\theta^\top P A_\theta - A_\theta^\top P B_\theta (R + B_\theta^\top P B_\theta)^{-1} B_\theta^\top P A_\theta + Q$, is ≥ 0 and vanishes iff $K = K^*$ (here $R + B_\theta^\top P B_\theta \succ 0$, $\Sigma_K \succ 0$). Existence/uniqueness of the stabilizing $P \succeq 0$ is the *DARE theorem* under (S2)–(S3) [7, Ch. 14–15], [6, Ch. 6]. Hence the minimizer $\Sigma^* = \Sigma_{K^*} \succ 0$, $L^* = K^* \Sigma^*$ is unique and $J_{\text{cont}} = \text{tr}(PW)$, which is (A2). (For $Q \succeq 0$ the final pinning of Σ^* uses $(A_\theta, Q^{1/2})$ detectability; for $Q \succ 0$ it is immediate.)

(c) C^1 value and dual-invariant gradient (the operational core). Because $J_{\text{cont}} = \text{tr}(PW)$ and $P(\theta)$ is a C^1 function of the data, the value is C^1 : apply the *implicit function theorem* to the DARE residual $\mathcal{R}(P, \theta) = 0$, whose P -derivative at a stabilizing root is the Stein operator $\delta P \mapsto \delta P - A_{\text{cl}}^* \delta P A_{\text{cl}}^*$, invertible exactly because A_{cl}^* is Schur (eigenvalues $1 - \lambda_i \bar{\lambda}_j \neq 0$). Now the key point that makes the gradient safe to read off *any* returned dual: by the *Danskin/Bonnans–Shapiro directional-derivative theorem* for optimal values of convex programs with a unique primal solution [3, Thm. 4.24],

$$V'(\theta; d) = \min_{(\mu, S) \in \mathcal{D}^*(\theta)} \langle \nabla_\theta L(z^*, \mu, S, \theta), d \rangle,$$

where $\mathcal{D}^*$ is the (compact convex) dual optimal set. Since V is C^1 , the left side is *linear* in d , so the min equals $\langle \nabla_\theta V, d \rangle$ for all d ; a fixed dual gives $\langle \nabla_\theta L, d \rangle \geq \langle \nabla_\theta V, d \rangle$ for all d (including $-d$), forcing equality $\nabla_\theta L = \nabla_\theta V$. Thus *every* optimal dual yields the same, correct gradient, and Corollary 1 of the paper holds under (S1)–(S3) *without* strict complementarity. Specialized to the Lyapunov LMI, $\nabla_\theta L$ is the paper’s $\partial J_{\text{cont}}/\partial A_\theta = -2S_{12}\Sigma^*$, etc.

The dual identity. Complementary slackness aligns range S^* with $\ker \mathcal{G}_c^* = \text{range}[I; -A_{\text{cl}}^{*\top}]$ (the tight Lyapunov block has rank n), so $S^* = [I; -A_{\text{cl}}^{*\top}]M[I; -A_{\text{cl}}^{*\top}]^\top$ and $S_{12}^* = -S_{11}^*A_{\text{cl}}^*$. Lagrangian stationarity in Σ then gives the closed-loop *Stein equation* $S_{11} = Q + K^{*\top}RK^* + A_{\text{cl}}^{*\top}S_{11}A_{\text{cl}}^*$, whose unique solution (A_{cl}^* Schur) is P ; hence $S_{11}^* = P$ and, via $S_{12}^* = -PA_{\text{cl}}^*$, $\partial J_{\text{cont}}/\partial A_\theta = -2S_{12}^*\Sigma^* = 2PA_{\text{cl}}^*\Sigma^*$, matching the Riccati gradient. (This is the identity corrected in the paper’s Appendix A: the off-diagonal dual block carries A_{cl}^* , not $K^{*\top}$.)

(d) Strict complementarity $\Rightarrow$ unique dual. Primal nondegeneracy at z^* implies the dual optimizer is unique and strict complementarity implies the primal–dual solution map is differentiable, by the *Alizadeh–Haeberly–Overton / Shapiro* characterization for SDPs [1, Thms. 10,15],[2, Thm. 4.1]. Here $\text{rank } \mathcal{G}_c^* = n$ always, so strict complementarity reduces to $\text{rank } S^* = n$ with $S^*\mathcal{G}_c^* = 0$, guaranteed by rank counting from $P \succeq Q \succ 0$, $R \succ 0$. This supplies (A3), completing Assumption 1.

2.1 The estimation SDP by transpose duality

The estimation SDP is (4) under the relabeling $A_\theta \mapsto A_\theta^\top$, $B_\theta \mapsto C_\theta^\top$, $W \mapsto Q$, $Q \mapsto W$, $R \mapsto V$, $(\Sigma, L, Z_0) \mapsto (P^\varepsilon, -F, Z_1)$. The hypotheses map correctly: (A_θ, B_θ) stabilizable $\leftrightarrow (A_\theta, C_\theta)$ detectable, and $(A_\theta, Q^{1/2})$ detectable $\leftrightarrow (A_\theta, W^{1/2})$ stabilizable (automatic since $W \succ 0$ makes it controllable). Every step above is invariant under this relabeling, so all conclusions transfer, giving the unique $P^{\varepsilon*} = \Sigma^\varepsilon$ (Kalman error covariance) and $S_{11}^* = \Sigma^\varepsilon$.

3 Appendix B: fixed- γ H_∞ regularity — sketch

For the robust inner problem the paper uses, at a *fixed* attenuation γ , the game Riccati route. With disturbance channel $E_\theta = W_\theta^{1/2}$, augmented input $\tilde{B}_\theta = [B_\theta \ E_\theta]$ and *indefinite* game weight $\tilde{R} = \text{diag}(R, -\gamma^2 I)$, the guaranteed cost is $V_{\text{wc}}(\theta) = \text{tr}(XW_\theta)$ with $X \succeq 0$ the stabilizing solution of the game GARE

$$X = Q + A_\theta^\top X A_\theta - A_\theta^\top X \tilde{B}_\theta (\tilde{R} + \tilde{B}_\theta^\top X \tilde{B}_\theta)^{-1} \tilde{B}_\theta^\top X A_\theta, \quad (6)$$

saddle gain $\tilde{K} = -(\tilde{R} + \tilde{B}_\theta^\top X \tilde{B}_\theta)^{-1} \tilde{B}_\theta^\top X A_\theta$, closed loop $A_{\text{cl}} = A_\theta + \tilde{B}_\theta \tilde{K}$.

Proposition 2 (Fixed- γ H_∞ regularity). *Fix γ above the optimal attenuation and let $X \succeq 0$ solve (6) with $R + B_\theta^\top X B_\theta \succ 0$ and A_{cl} Schur. Then X is a locally unique C^1 function of θ , $V_{\text{wc}}(\theta) = \text{tr}(XW_\theta) \in C^1$, with the closed-form gradient (9) below. The dual filter GARE is regular under the analogous conditions, giving $V_{\text{est}}(\theta) = \text{tr}(M\Sigma_e) \in C^1$.*

The proof is the Riccati (implicit-function) half of Section 2, carried through with an indefinite weight; there is no SDP dual and no strict-complementarity requirement.

(a) Stabilizing solution. For γ above the optimal attenuation γ^* , the *discrete dynamic-game (bounded-real) Riccati theorem* gives a unique $X \succeq 0$ solving (6) with $R + B_\theta^\top X B_\theta \succ 0$, full pivot $\tilde{R} + \tilde{B}_\theta^\top X \tilde{B}_\theta$ nonsingular of inertia (m, r_w) , and A_{cl} Schur [8],[5, Ch. 2]. This is the fixed- γ analog of the DARE existence used in Section 2; approaching γ^* makes the pivot lose rank (the minimal- γ SDP degeneracy the paper avoids), so we stay strictly above it.

(b) Lyapunov (completion-of-squares) form. Substituting $\tilde{K}$ into $Q + A_{\text{cl}}^\top X A_{\text{cl}} + \tilde{K}^\top \tilde{R} \tilde{K}$ and cancelling yields

$$X = Q + \tilde{K}^\top \tilde{R} \tilde{K} + A_{\text{cl}}^\top X A_{\text{cl}}, \quad (7)$$

identical algebra to the LQG identity below (5); completion of squares never uses the sign of $\tilde{R}$, which is why indefiniteness is harmless.

(c) Local uniqueness and C^1 (the heart). The GARE residual $\mathcal{R}(X, \theta)$ (right minus left of (6)) is C^1 wherever the pivot is nonsingular, hence near a stabilizing root. Because $\tilde{K}$ is the *saddle point* of the inner game (nonsingular pivot), the game envelope annihilates the gain's first-order variation and the partial derivative in X collapses to the Stein operator

$$\partial_X \mathcal{R}(X, \theta)[\delta X] = A_{\text{cl}}^\top \delta X A_{\text{cl}} - \delta X, \quad (8)$$

invertible precisely because A_{cl} is Schur. The *implicit function theorem* then gives a unique C^1 branch $\theta \mapsto X(\theta)$ through the stabilizing root, and with it C^1 maps $\tilde{K}(\theta), A_{\text{cl}}(\theta)$ and the game gramian $S(\theta)$ solving $S = A_{\text{cl}} S A_{\text{cl}}^\top + W_\theta$. This is Proposition 2; note it needs no dual and no strict complementarity — the regularity is read straight off the Riccati map, unlike the SDP route of Section 2.

(d) C^1 value and gradient. $V_{\text{wc}} = \text{tr}(X W_\theta)$ is C^1 by (c) and (S1). Differentiating (7), saddle stationarity of $\tilde{K}$ kills all $d\tilde{K}$ terms, so dX solves the Stein equation $dX - A_{\text{cl}}^\top dX A_{\text{cl}} = \Xi$ with source $\Xi = dQ + \tilde{K}^\top d\tilde{R} \tilde{K} + A_{\text{cl}}^\top X (dA_\theta + d\tilde{B}_\theta \tilde{K}) + (\cdot)^\top$. Contracting with the gramian and using $\text{tr}(W_\theta dX) = \text{tr}(S(dX - A_{\text{cl}}^\top dX A_{\text{cl}})) = \text{tr}(S\Xi)$ gives, term by term,

$$\frac{\partial V_{\text{wc}}}{\partial A_\theta} = 2X A_{\text{cl}} S, \quad \frac{\partial V_{\text{wc}}}{\partial \tilde{B}_\theta} = 2X A_{\text{cl}} S \tilde{K}^\top, \quad \frac{\partial V_{\text{wc}}}{\partial Q} = S, \quad \frac{\partial V_{\text{wc}}}{\partial \tilde{R}} = \tilde{K} S \tilde{K}^\top, \quad (9)$$

plus the explicit $\partial V_{\text{wc}}/\partial W_\theta = X$ from the objective. The channel $E_\theta = W_\theta^{1/2}$ enters through the E -block of $\partial V_{\text{wc}}/\partial \tilde{B}_\theta$, so a design coordinate moving both the objective weight W_θ and the channel E_θ sums the two contributions (the data-object chain rule of Assumption 1(A4)).

(e) Filter GARE by duality; (f) the H_2 limit. Under the transpose substitution $A_\theta \mapsto A_\theta^\top$, $\tilde{B}_\theta \mapsto [C_\theta^\top \ L_e^\top]$, $\tilde{R} \mapsto \text{diag}(V, -\gamma^2 I)$, the worst-case error covariance Σ_e solves the control GARE on the dual data, so (a)–(d) transfer and $V_{\text{est}} = \text{tr}(M \Sigma_e) \in C^1$ with the dual gradient. Finally, as $\gamma \rightarrow \infty$ the $-\gamma^2 I$ pivot block deactivates, (6) reduces to the control DARE, $X \rightarrow P$, $S \rightarrow \Sigma^*$, and (9) collapses to the LQG gradients of Section 2: the H_2 /LQG result is the $\gamma \rightarrow \infty$ boundary of this one.

4 What each proof rests on

- **Slater (LQG only)** $\Leftarrow$ a stabilizing feedback plus an εI inflation, i.e. the controllability/observability data, with $W, V \succ 0$ supplying the strict margin; conic strong duality then gives (A1) [3, 4].

- **Primal uniqueness** $\Leftarrow$ the (game) Riccati equation: the covariance/certificate SDP is an exact convex lift whose optimizer is the (G)ARE solution [7, 6, 8], pinned by completion of squares.
- **Differentiability and gradient correctness** $\Leftarrow$ the *implicit function theorem* through the Stein operator (A_{cl} Schur), which alone makes the value C^1 ; and, in the SDP case, the *Danskin/Bonnans–Shapiro* formula, which makes the envelope gradient *dual-invariant* — so the returned-dual gradient is exact even without strict complementarity [3].
- **Dual uniqueness (A3)** $\Leftarrow$ strict complementarity / nondegeneracy in the *Alizadeh–Haeberly–Overton* sense [1, 2]; needed only for the “unique dual” upgrade, not for a correct gradient.
- **H_∞ vs. LQG.** The H_∞ proof is the Riccati half only: IFT + Stein operator + gradient, with an indefinite weight and no SDP dual. It therefore never needs Slater, dual invariance, or strict complementarity — the fixed- γ GARE is well-posed by construction, and the H_2 case is its $\gamma \rightarrow \infty$ limit.

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